

participated in the event. The State Government had worked hard for the last year and a half to bring the exercise to its logical culmination. The global investors' meet was first mooted in early 2004. Chief Minister Shivraj Singh Chauhan finally realised that dream.

The seeds of the summit were laid in the new industrial promotion policy released in 2004 and the step-wise programme began in August 2006. From Nov 4-12 the same year, a State delegation facilitated by FICCI wooed investors in Italy for investing in automobile manufacturing in Madhya Pradesh. From Dec 9-14, 2006, the State Government held a road-show in Singapore and Malaysia where five MoUs were signed. Followed by a presentation before NRIs at the Aprawasi Bharatiya Diwas in Delhi in January 2007. Then came the time to test the waters for the first time at the Khajuraho Investors' Meet from Jan 15-17 where potential investors (45 NRI and 225 Indian) were present in strength. The state government once again came out with flying colours, having signed 18 MoUs with an investment potential of 31,000 crore.

At the Global Investors' Summit, Anil Ambani recalled how he was taken in by Shivraj's simplicity at the Mumbai road-show where 400 corporate heads and businessmen were present and as many as 45 including the likes of Mukesh Ambani, Adi Godrej and KM Birla had a one-on-one session with the CM. Groups like Manipal who have unveiled plans for the State were approached in Bangalore road-show on August 30 where the CM met IT honchos like Azim Premji of WIPRO and Krish Gopalakrishnan of Infosys.

Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce and Industry (FICCI) was the State Government's key partner in promoting the investors' summit. FICCI Secretary General Dr. Amit Mitra, who was bullish on the prospects of investment in Madhya Pradesh, says, "MP has a young, dynamic and vibrant leader in Shivraj Singh Chauhan. With dedicated efforts now visible, the State can take off on the growth trajectory."

What is noteworthy is the proposals from companies like Tech Mahindra, Netlink and Impetus in software development, Genpact and First Source in BPO and Cintiv Finland in ITES for investment in IT sector. An apex level committee headed by the Chief Minister grants concessions. It has cleared concession packages for 60 units with a combined Rs. 12,453 crore investment since being formed.

No wonder the people of the state today look forward to the

Other highlights of MP Government:

- Reservation for women in local bodies raised from 33 to 50 per cent. 10 per cent reservation to women in police force
- Focus on gender justice. From gender budgeting in 13 departments to schemes like Laadali Lakshmi Yojana
- Ban on recruitment of general category candidates lifted. Half of the over 50,000 posts of teachers to be women
- Interest rate on Cooperative loans to farmers lowered to seven per cent
- Scholarships and facilities for tribal students enhanced. In 11 districts, tribal families to get three milch bovines each
- New medical college in Sagar, new veterinary college in Rewa, new agriculture college in Ganj Basoda (Vidisha), new Sanskrit university in Ujjain after Maharishi Panini
- Jalabhishek Abhiyaan and Hariyali Abhiyaan for conserving rain water and increasing green cover. 100 per cent grant for scheduled communities for turning their fields into irrigation ponds
- 20,000 new Anganwadi centres approved. Five lakh women roped in to provide nutritious food. Honorarium for Anganwadi workers raised by Rs. 300 and for assistants by Rs. 150
- 1100 ambulances for providing immediate medical assistance in villages. 400 vehicles to be commissioned in the first phase
- Unprecedented hike in budgets for women and child development, sports and youth welfare and tourism
- E-tendering process launched to promote transparency
- 50 per cent DA of Government employees merged in their basic salary. Recommendations of Brahmaswaroop Committee accepted to remove anomalies in wage structures. Honorarium of Kotwars increased
- Free books to all 12 lakh children under class 8. Free uniforms to 55 lakh girl students and free cycles to girls of 9th class who study in schools in other villages and same facility to girl from 6th class if she belongs to scheduled Caste or tribe
- Suraj Abhiyan to make administration more public-oriented. Tele- Samadhan to solve problems registered over telephone
- Fiscal deficit reduced. No overdraft in last four years. More resources mobilised for power, roads and irrigation
- Mukhya Mantri Majdoor Suraksha Yojana launched to provide social security cover to landless farm workers

future with optimism, the business sentiment is upbeat and the state machinery is crackling with action to bring the developmental process to fruition.

